



The Deep Sea



The bottom of the deep sea. What have you heard or read about the deep sea? Is it dark down there? Can we get down to the bottom of the ocean?

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The ocean is made up of three zones.
The sunlight zone gets heat from the sun.
The twilight zone is cold and dark.
The midnight zone gets no sunlight at all.

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In the bottom layers of the sea, there is total darkness. In this dark twilight, animals can exist. The animals down here have adapted to the harsh environment. The fish are soft. Some of the deep-sea animals can make their own light.

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Deep-sea angler fish have a long, thin rod on their head with a light on the end of it. This is a fin ray. Other fish see the light and swim to it. The angler fish catches them to eat. It acts like a fishing rod.

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Today, we have found out a lot about the deep sea and the animals within it, because of scientists and their use of underwater robots.

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Scientists use robots to discover and understand what lies at the bottom of the ocean. Underwater robots are connected to a ship by a long power cable.

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Pilots on the ship control the robot and can see with a camera. The camera zooms in on the sea floor and the robot arms can pick up objects. Yet, there is still so much to learn about the deep sea.

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